

Cohen Counters With His Aces

Littlefield, Rehm
Braves' Moundsmen

By Special Eagle Correspondent

DENVER, June 25 — Momentarily thwarted by a heavy rainstorm Tuesday night the Wichita Braves hope to resume their recent manhandling of Denver's Bears in a double header Wednesday evening.

Manager Ben Geraghty will have Dick Littlefield, his new ace, ready to take the mound in one game but was undecided whether to open with Vic Rehm or Dave Jolly in the other half of the twin bill.

Rehm fared poorly Tuesday when the Grizzlies used his wildness with three base hits for four runs before the game was wiped out with Denver at bat in the bottom of the first inning.

Just One of Those Things

Geraghty, however, was inclined to wave off Rehm's poor start as one of those things and indicated he didn't want the hard throwing left hander to miss his turn.

Manager Andy Cohen will throw his top pitchers — John Gabler and Mark Freeman—at the Braves in the two games. Gabler, in quest of his 11th triumph, started against Rehm Tuesday and faced only three men in one inning. Casey Wise managed a ground single into center field but was promptly wiped out on a double play when Eddie Haas bounded to Curt Roberts at second.

General Manager Lynn Stone joined the team, combining business with some fishing in Rocky Mountain National Park. He remains in the Mile High city for the remainder of the series, but said there was nothing significant in his joining the team.

"We're moving up," Stone said. "Only six and one half games from the top and this team, with its fine pitching, is very much in the race."

Denver diehards could not argue with Stone on this point after the Braves had scuttled the league leading Bears four straight. The Grizzlies could not exceed five hits in four of five meetings with Wichita, which is evidence aplenty that the Braves' mound corps has the right formula against Denver.

Littlefield blanked the Bears for his fourth straight win since joining the Braves last week at Wichita.

A crowd of 5,062 was on hand Tuesday night for the postponed game. It saw Rehm issue three walks, singles to Gordie Windhorn and Vern Rapp and a double to Fritz Brickell for the four runs.

Corky Valentine took over and also was wild as he passed Curt Hardaway and Gabler before the downpour struck. After a wait of an hour and 40 minutes Umpire Dave Carabba decided the evening was unplayable, although the field remained in comparatively good condition.